Chords in Minor Keys

Triads in a minor key are built from the notes of the scale, as in major keys. The primary chords of a minor key are built on degrees 1, 4, and 5.

- The tonic triad, **i**, is minor: in A minor, A, C, E.
- The subdominant triad, **iv**, is minor: in A minor, D, F, A.
- The dominant triad, **V**, uses the raised 7th from harmonic minor, so it is major: in A minor, E, G♯, B.

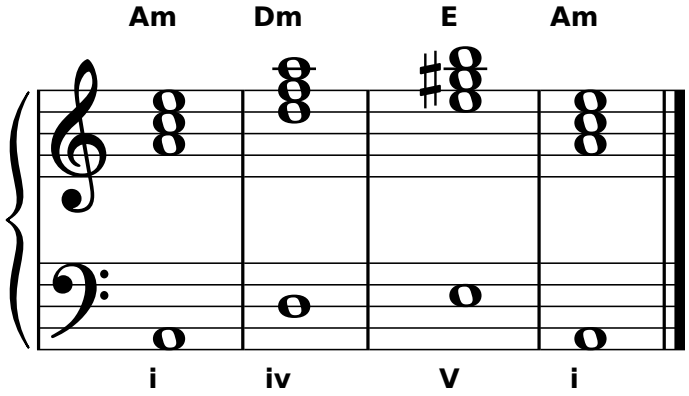
Small Roman numerals mark minor triads and capital numerals mark major triads, as in Chapter 18. The raised 7th in V is the leading tone. It pulls up to the tonic, so V to i makes a strong cadence, as V to I does in a major key.

The table lists the primary chords of the seven minor keys in this book. In every key the V chord needs an accidental: the raised 7th is the third of the V triad.

Key	i	iv	V
A minor	Am	Dm	E
E minor	Em	Am	B
B minor	Bm	Em	F♯
F♯ minor	F♯m	Bm	C♯
D minor	Dm	Gm	A
G minor	Gm	Cm	D
C minor	Cm	Fm	G

A cadence in A minor

The progression i–iv–V–i is the minor-key version of the progression in Chapter 19. Listen for the G♯ in the V chord resolving up to A.



i–iv–V–i in A minor. The left hand plays each root; the right hand plays the triad.

Chord symbols in minor keys

Chord symbols work the same way in every key: Am is A, C, E; Dm is D, F, A; E is E, G♯, B. A player reading a lead sheet in A minor sees Am, Dm, and E, and builds each triad from its root.

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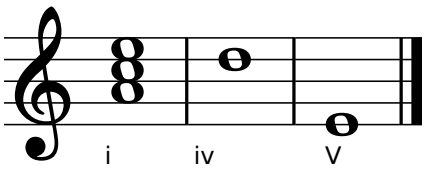
Name _____ Date _____

Chords in Minor Keys

A. Write the primary chords Add the third and fifth above each root to write i, iv, and V. Add the accidental the V chord needs.

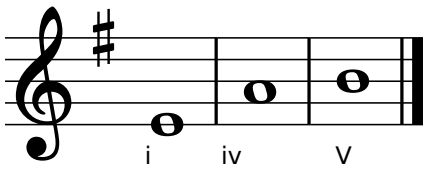
A minor

EXAMPLE 1. 2.



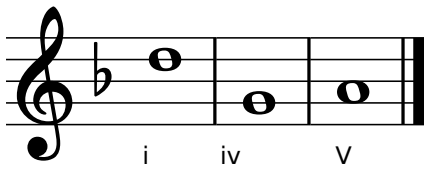
E minor

3. 4. 5.



D minor

6. 7. 8.



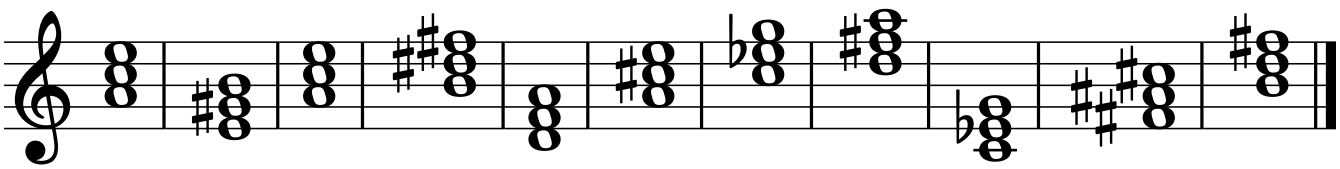
B. Chord symbols in minor keys Write the chord symbol for each chord.

EXAMPLE V in A minor: E

1. iv in E minor: _____
2. i in D minor: _____
3. V in E minor: _____
4. iv in G minor: _____
5. V in D minor: _____
6. i in F♯ minor: _____
7. V in C minor: _____
8. iv in A minor: _____
9. V in B minor: _____

C. Major or minor Write major or minor under each triad from a minor key.

EXAMPLE 1. 2. 3. 4. 5. 6. 7. 8. 9. 10.



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Name _____ Date _____

Review: Minor Keys

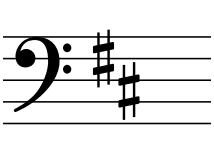
A. Major and minor keys Write the name of the minor key for each key signature.

EXAMPLE



G minor

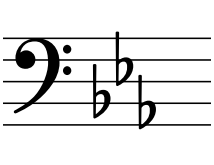
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2.



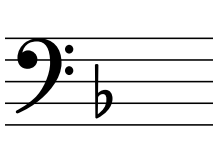
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4.

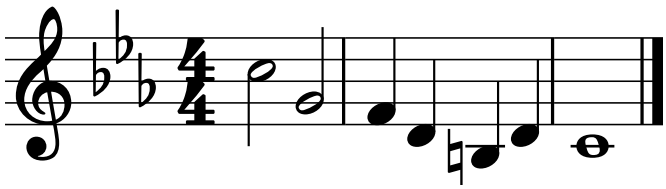


5.



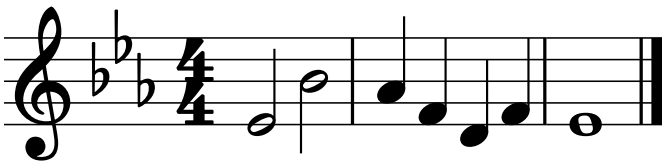
B. Name the key Write the key of each melody.

EXAMPLE



C minor

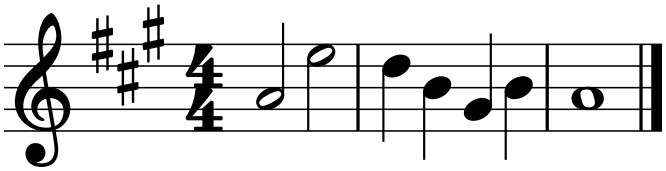
1.



2.

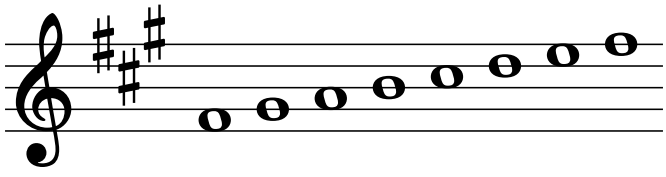


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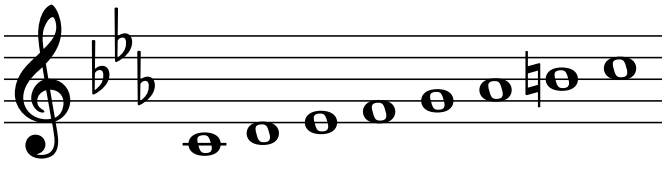
C. Name the form Write natural, harmonic, or melodic for each ascending scale.

EXAMPLE

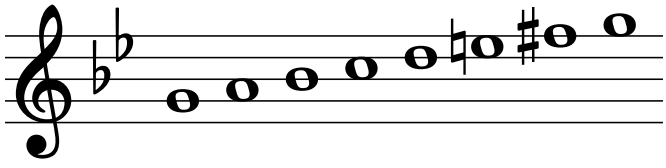


natural

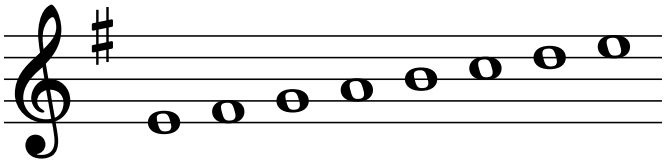
1.



2.



3.



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